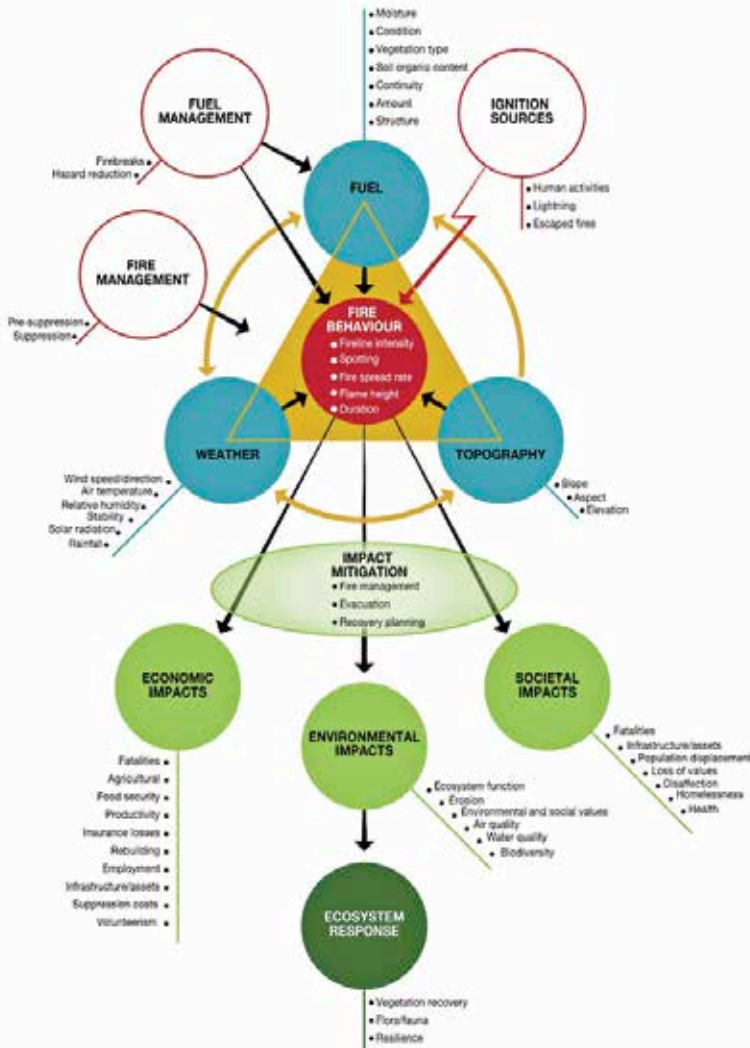




Insta Shopping via DMs
Instagram announced a deeper integration of Instagram Shops and Direct Messages features.
<https://digit.in/aug22-34>

Factors influencing wildfire outcomes and management actions



Source: UNEP

of the changing global carbon cycle. They tend to increase the positive feedback loop of the cycle, thus making it more difficult to combat the increase in Earth's temperature. Not only this, the fires negatively impact water catchments, facilitating unwanted erosion and inflicting extensive damage to the productivity of the soil in the affected region.

The wildlife in the affected areas also has to bear with the severe consequences of forest fires. It has been proven that the increased instances of forest fires are pushing certain species of the animal kingdom towards extinction. This, in turn, affects the balance of the ecological balance of that area, the effects of which can be felt trickling down to our day-to-day lives in one way or another.

ANSWERS... ANYONE?

Having read about wildfires' effects and other statistics, it may look like there's no hope. But, if the right steps are taken, and things are done in the manner in which they are supposed to be, there's still a chance.

At institutional and governmental levels, the UNEP report called for the adoption of a new 'Fire Ready Formula'. This would include developing a better understanding of ecosystem restoration, preparing better for facing adversity, and establishing a concrete plan to restore things effectively in the aftermath of such instances.

Individually, there's little that can be done. However, even small efforts by the billions of people living on Earth can bring about a big change. Cutting down on environmentally damaging practices can surely be of help. If you spot wildfires, you can report them to the authorities too, helping them contain the damage at the earliest. All you will have to do is go to the Forest Survey of India (FSI) webpage and file a report on the Forest Fire Portal operated by the institution.

Apart from this, educating yourself more and spreading the message about the effects of forest fires can work wonders as well.

Source: FSI

Category	Forest cover (in sq km)	% of Total forest cover
Extremely Fire Prone	20,074.47	2.81
Very Highly Fire Prone	56,049.35	7.85
Highly Fire Prone	82,900.17	11.61
Moderately Fire Prone	94,126.68	13.19
Less Fire Prone	4,60,638.36	64.54
Total	7,13,789.03	100.00

India's forest cover classification according to susceptibility to fires

reported to be prone to forest fires. So, with the worsening conditions, it's anyone's guess what might unfold in the coming years.

SWOTHEATS

We cannot afford to have forest fires

happening at the rate they are happening right now, and certainly not at the level they are projected to rise to in the coming years. The effects of these fires are much worse than what we can imagine to be. Even the smallest of forest fires contribute to the problem